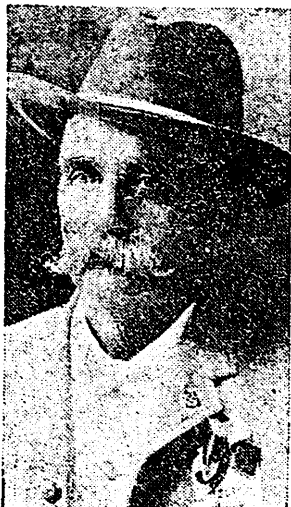


SOLE SURVIVOR OF HIS COMPANY JOINS COMRADES



William A. Thomas.

CIVIL WAR VETERAN BURIED IN METAIRIE

Prominent Construction Man Widely Known in Dock Circles Dies.

William A. Thomas, pioneer Orleanian and Civil War veteran, who throughout an active career was prominently identified with dock and levee construction, died Saturday at the family residence, 1520 St. Mary's street. He was 80 years old. A military funeral, attended by veterans of '81, was held from the home and burial was made in the family tomb at Metairie, with the sounding of "taps," by a bugler veteran of the world war.

Mr. Thomas came here as a boy in 1841 with his father, who was an English architect, and was commissioned to adjust the acoustics of the old St. Charles Theater. The younger Thomas became interested in building and construction. He served the city as an expert in the erection of the Mississippi levees in this section and, up to eight years ago, was superintendent of construction for the Dock Board.

When the Civil War broke out Mr. Thomas joined Company F of the Orlean Southerners under Colonel Hunt. That outfit, known as Hay's Brigade, engaged in active combat in many of the major battles of the Northern and Southern armies. At the battle of Gettysburg Mr. Thomas was the sole survivor of his company.

Besides his widow, Mrs. Jane Henderson Thomas, the deceased leaves a son, John J. Thomas; four daughters, Mrs. Mary S. Yount, Mrs. Reuben Chisolm, Mrs. R. T. Clagett and Mrs. Juan Argate, nine grandchildren and four great-grandchildren.